

Chapter 28-5

The early autumn wind was strong. Xu Qingzhu's long hair hung wetly on her body, and her water-green dress clung tightly to her.

Liang Xinhe told her to go, saying he would handle things here, but Xu Qingzhu shook her head.

"I'll settle this account for Liang Shi." Liang Xinhe said: "Don't worry, go change your clothes first, be careful not to catch cold."

Xu Qingzhu took a light breath: "Second brother, let me handle this."

Zhou Yi'an was already planning to leave. She had just turned around when Xu Qingzhu called out: "Miss Zhou."

Zhou Yi'an turned back, raising her eyebrows contemptuously: "What? Do you want to condemn me too?"

Xu Qingzhu walked over and raised her hand to deliver a slap.

Zhou Yi'an was completely stunned.

Everyone present was also stunned.

Father Zhou had just arrived. When he heard his daughter had caused trouble, he immediately rushed over, only to see his daughter being slapped.

Father Zhou: "....."

His heart was filled with mixed emotions.

When Zhou Yi'an raised her hand to slap back, she was blocked by Liang Xinhe.

Xu Qingzhu stood in the wind, her slender figure seeming like it could be blown away at any moment, but when she looked at Zhou Yi'an, her gaze was firm and her words rang out forcefully: "This slap was for my wife. She can't swim well, but you knowingly pushed her into the water. If we hadn't arrived in time, what we would have seen would be a corpse. My parents-in-law would have had to bury their child, I would have lost my wife, and the child in my belly would lose her mother before being born. How would you have me raise her?"

Everyone's gaze toward Zhou Yi'an instantly changed.

Put this way, Zhou Yi'an was a criminal!

It would be a pity not to send her to prison for a few years.

But Xu Qingzhu continued: "Mr. Zhou works to establish livelihood for the people¹ and create peace for all generations, but what are you doing as his daughter? You're treating human life carelessly! You're bringing shame to him! You're adding a dark stain to his otherwise upright career. Your reckless behavior shows you don't regard China's criminal law, you despise human life, you despise the law. Even though I'm just an insignificant ordinary citizen, I can see Mr. Zhou's contributions. He works hard for the people, but you're ruining his reputation. I feel sorry for him."

This speech directly elevated the entire incident.

Even Father Zhou, standing behind, couldn't help but feel angry along with her.

He usually kept his tail between his legs², working diligently and conscientiously, only to have his beloved daughter making enemies everywhere?

This was truly unbearable.

Xu Qingzhu finally took a heavy breath: "I believe Miss Zhou definitely won't let our married couple off after today's events, but we won't be afraid either. After all, I believe heaven's justice is clear³, and there is royal law and justice. If one day we two unfortunately meet with harm, Miss Zhou will definitely be the police's first suspect."

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

"Fuck!" Zhou Yi'an was so angry she cursed.

Father Zhou had already left the scene and didn't stand up to speak for Zhou Yi'an.

Everyone understood—Mr. Zhou had given up on Zhou Yi'an.

Just as Liang Xinhe was about to step forward, the silent Liang Xinzhou spoke first: "Although the Liang family is just in business, that doesn't mean anyone can bully us. Even if my sister has done wrong, it's for our family to discipline her. If she breaks the law, naturally the law will punish her. I don't know what kind of vigilante justice Miss Zhou thinks she's dispensing? Is this still the 21st century?"

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

Liang Xinzhou said: "If anything happens to my sister in the future, the first person the Liang family will suspect is definitely Miss Zhou."

"On what grounds?" Zhou Yi'an frowned. "Are you all crazy?!"

"On the grounds that you have precedent." Liang Xinhe and Liang Xinzhou said simultaneously.

After the farce ended, Liang Xinhe lowered his voice and asked: "Sister-in-law, are you pregnant?"

Xu Qingzhu said calmly: "I was lying to her."

To stir up emotions, the elderly and children were often most effective.

Liang Xinhe: "....."

He hadn't expected that his seemingly gentle and weak sister-in-law could kill without a blade⁴.

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When Liang Shi was helped inside by the waiter, Qiu Zimin and the others happened to come out of the room.

The group had been playing mahjong all evening and were now somewhat tired, planning to find a place to rest.

Seeing Liang Shi being helped in, Qiu Zimin's expression immediately changed: "What happened?"

"Nothing..." Liang Shi still maintained her weak image.

The waiter beside her answered: "Third Miss just fell into the water."

Qiu Zimin immediately cleared the way: "Help Miss to rest, and have someone prepare ginger syrup."

The waiter nodded: "Yes."

"Is this A-Shi?" A woman's voice suddenly rang out.

Liang Shi saw Qiu Zimin's shoulders tremble, then she turned around with a fawning smile: "Yes, Mrs. Qi."

The person called Mrs. Qi wore a blue-green qipao⁵ that beautifully outlined her graceful waist curves. She wore a jade bracelet on her arm and walked unhurriedly to Liang Shi's side, raising her hand to touch her face: "It's been so long since we met. You've grown so much."

This arm gave Liang Shi a very strong sense of familiarity.

She frowned and avoided it.

"It's been so long." Mrs. Qi smiled: "Has A-Shi forgotten me?"

Her fingers were painted with crimson nail polish: "That would make me sad."

Liang Shi frowned slightly as a memory suddenly flashed through her mind.

It was this jade bracelet.

It was this hand that pulled her into the dark room, stripped the young her of her clothes, and made her stand facing the wall as punishment.

More precisely, it was the original owner.

The fear remaining in this body awakened at this moment, and she couldn't help but shiver.

Liang Shi remained silent and didn't answer her words.

Mrs. Qi said: "Well, we'll have a good chat next time we have the chance. Go change your clothes."

She glanced over Liang Shi's chest: "Our A-Shi has grown up."

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ Establish livelihood for the people - A classical Chinese phrase referring to creating conditions for people to make a living and prosper.

² Kept his tail between his legs - Chinese idiom meaning to behave cautiously and humbly, keeping a low profile.

³ Heaven's justice is clear - A traditional Chinese belief that heaven sees all and will ensure justice is served.

⁴ Kill without a blade - Chinese idiom meaning to harm someone through words or psychological means rather than physical violence.

⁵ Qipao - A traditional Chinese dress, also known as cheongsam, characterized by its high collar and form-fitting silhouette.

Author's Note: [If any author's notes were present in the original text, they would be translated here]